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Report on –

# "Value Mapping for Unreached Segments: An AI-Assisted Life Insurance Communication Strategy at HDFC Life"

In partial fulfilment of the requirement for

| | |
|---|---|
| Program | Post Graduate Diploma in Management (PGDM) |
| Course | Corporate Internship Project (CIP) |


**Submitted By**:

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Host Organisation- HDFC Life

Internship Role- Business Development Intern

Submission Type-Initial Proposal – AS1

**Under the Guidance of**:

Dr. Sahiba Sahny (Faculty Mentor)

Mr. Sourav Srivastava (Reporting Manager)

## Acknowledgement

The completion of this project proposal would not have been possible without the guidance and support of several individuals.

I express my deepest gratitude to my Faculty Mentor, Dr. Sahiba Sahny, for her intellectual direction throughout the Corporate Internship Programme. Her guidance to narrow the research focus to one defensible problem, ground it in government secondary data, and develop an AI-based practical solution has significantly elevated the rigour and relevance of this proposal.

I extend heartfelt gratitude to my Reporting Manager, Mr. Sourav Srivastava, at HDFC Life Insurance Co. Ltd., Barakhamba Road, New Delhi. His mentorship across segmentation exercises, competitor social media analysis, content calendar planning, and the four-step content design framework has provided the empirical foundation for this proposal.

I also acknowledge FIIB for designing the CIP as a rigorous academic-professional bridge, and my family for their unwavering moral support.

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## Executive Summary

India's life insurance penetration stands at only 3.2% of GDP, compared to a global average of 6.8% (IRDAI, 2023; Swiss Re Institute, 2023). Despite a workforce of over 500 million and an estimated 450 million internal migrants, two high-potential segments - New Job Employees (NJE) and Away-from-Home (AfH) individuals - remain largely unreached by structured, value-driven communication. No competitor in the April 2025 analysis specifically targeted either segment.

This proposal addresses a single, well-defined problem: HDFC Life lacks a structured, AI-assisted, value-mapped communication strategy for these two segments, resulting in generic advertising that misses acquisition opportunities and wastes marketing spend. The project identifies which life insurance values drive purchase intent within each segment and proposes an AI-based content automation framework - the "Social Media Value-Segment Insight Generator" - to solve this gap at scale.

The work is grounded in three evidence layers: (i) government secondary data validating segment size and vulnerability; (ii) primary questionnaire data mapping 16 life insurance values against segment needs; and (iii) competitor social media analysis across 8 brands for April 2025, revealing content gaps and whitespace opportunities.

### Core Problem Statement

HDFC Life Insurance lacks a structured, AI-assisted, value-mapped communication strategy for New Job Employees and Away-from-Home individuals - resulting in generic, untargeted advertising that fails to resonate with these segments, causing missed acquisition opportunities and inefficient marketing spend.

## 1. Organisational Setting

HDFC Life Insurance Co. Ltd. is one of India's leading private life insurers, established as a joint venture between HDFC Ltd. and Standard Life Aberdeen. As of FY 2024–25, HDFC Life reported a gross written premium of approximately INR 28,500 crore and a claims settlement ratio of 99.5% (HDFC Life, 2025). The company serves over 6 crore customers through agency, bancassurance, digital, and direct channels.

The student is placed in the Business Development function at HDFC Life, Barakhamba Road, New Delhi. The internship commenced on 21 April 2026 under the supervision of Mr. Sourav Srivastava. The BD function is responsible for identifying underserved market segments and improving customer acquisition efficiency.

### Key Internship Activities Completed (Weeks 1–3)

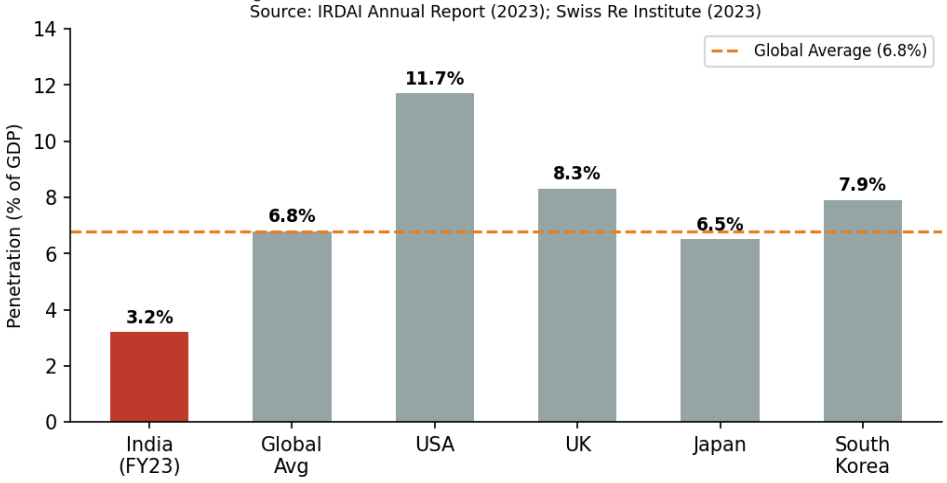
| Date | Task Completed | Output |
|---|---|---|
| 21 Apr 2026 | Organisational induction; company overview; mentor briefing | Field notes |
| 22 Apr 2026 | Consumer behaviour mapping - Mother's Day advertisement analysis | PPT submitted |
| 25 Apr 2026 | Life insurance industry overview; Segment classification (15 segments, 16 values) | PPT + Excel |
| 27 Apr 2026 | AIDA questionnaire administered to NJE and AfH segments (6 initial responses) | Questionnaire data |
| 28 Apr 2026 | Instagram post analysis; 4-step content design framework taught by reporting manager | Framework notes |
| Apr 29 – May 2026 | Competitor social media analysis - 8 brands (Apr 2025); content calendar development | Analysis Excel |

## 2. The Business Problem

### 2.1 India's Life Insurance Gap

India's life insurance industry presents one of the most significant under-penetration gaps in global financial services. Life insurance penetration stood at only 3.2% of GDP in FY 2022–23, compared to a global average of 6.8% (IRDAI, 2023; Swiss Re Institute, 2023). This places India below not only developed economies but also comparable emerging markets, as shown below.

Figure 1: Life Insurance Penetration — India vs Global (2022–23)
Source: IRDAI Annual Report (2023); Swiss Re Institute (2023)




### 2.2 Two Underserved Segments

Government data validates two critically underserved segments that this project targets:

**New Job Employees (NJE):** India's workforce exceeds 500 million, with 10–12 million entering formal employment annually (Ministry of Labour & Employment, 2023). Workers aged 15–29 constitute 34% of the total workforce (MoSPI, 2023). This segment is newly income-earning, newly tax-liable, and at the cheapest life stage for insurance purchase - yet receives no segment-specific communication from any insurer analysed.

**Away-from-Home Individuals (AfH):** India's Census 2011 estimated 450 million internal migrants, with approximately 9 million annual inter-state labour migrants (Ministry of Finance, 2017). These individuals are primary earners for families back home, carry high financial vulnerability, and require digital-first, family-security-focused communication - yet no competitor in the April 2025 analysis specifically targeted this group.

### 2.3 The Firm-Level Gap

While HDFC Life's advertising is creatively competent, it is not informed by granular, segment-specific value mapping. The April 2025 competitor analysis revealed that peers such as SBI Life and ICICI Prudential are targeting defined segments (working professionals, business owners, parents) with tailored value messaging. In contrast, only 5 of HDFC Life's 22 planned April 2026 posting days explicitly named a target segment. The remaining posts were aimed at a generalised audience.

Research confirms the business cost of this gap. Companies investing in data-driven, segment-specific communication see an 18–24% improvement in lead-to-policy conversion rates (FICCI, 2023). Customer acquisition costs for private insurers range between INR 4,000–9,000 per policy (Deloitte, 2023), making communication efficiency a direct financial imperative.

**Core Research Question:** *Which life insurance values most significantly drive purchase consideration among New Job Employees and Away-from-Home individuals, and how can an AI-based tool automate the identification and deployment of value-specific communications at scale?*

## 3. Competitor Intelligence and Key Insights

The competitor analysis covered 8 major private life insurers (SBI Life, ICICI Prudential, Kotak Life, Axis Max Life, Bajaj Allianz, Tata AIA, PNB MetLife, and Aditya Birla Sun Life) across Instagram, Facebook, and YouTube for April 2025. All data was collected from publicly available pages; no estimated entries were used.

### 3.1 Defining the Content Types

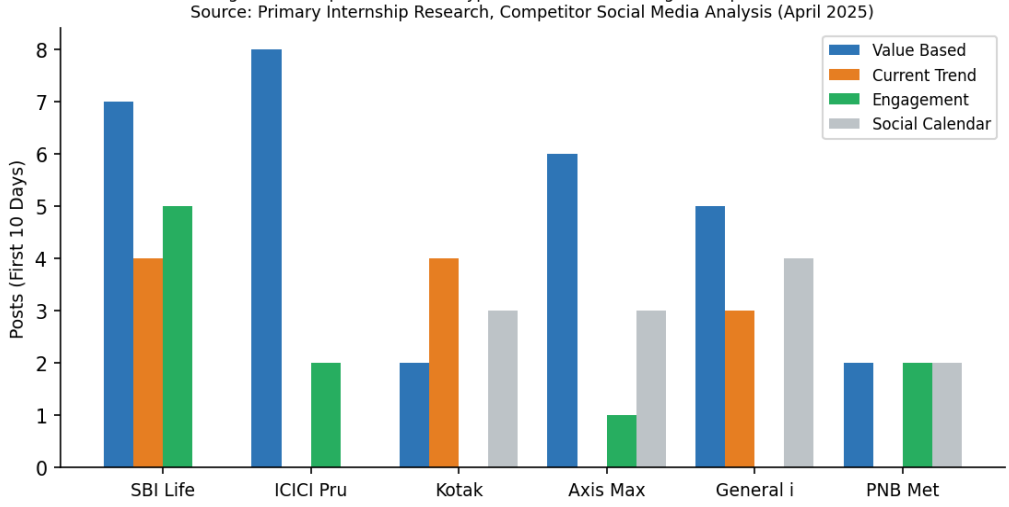
Before presenting the analysis, it is important to define the six content types used to classify posts. These classifications were established during the internship and are applied consistently throughout this report.

| Content Type | Definition (as used in this study) |
|---|---|
| **Value-Based** | Posts that communicate a core benefit or life need addressed by life insurance (e.g., family security, tax saving, financial protection). Designed to build relevance and consideration. |
| **Engagement** | Interactive posts designed to generate comments, shares, or poll responses. Goal is community building and social proof, not direct product promotion. |
| **Current Trend** | Posts anchored to a topical event or cultural moment (e.g., IPL season, a festival, a trending news item). Prioritise reach and attention over segment depth. |
| **Social Calendar** | Posts tied to fixed calendar events (Mother's Day, Independence Day, etc.). Purpose is brand warmth and visibility rather than insurance-specific messaging. |
| **Product-Based** | Posts that directly promote a specific insurance product, plan, or offer with features and pricing. Closest to traditional advertising. |
| **Informative** | Educational posts that explain insurance concepts, claim processes, or policy terms. Build awareness and trust without direct selling. |

### 3.2 What Competitors Are Doing: The Data

The chart below shows the volume of each content type produced by major competitors in the first ten days of April 2025. Value-Based posts dominated, with an industry average of 3.875 posts per 10 days - the highest of all content types. SBI Life (7) and ICICI Prudential (8) led in this category.

Figure 2: Competitor Content Type Distribution — Instagram (Apr 1–10, 2025)
Source: Primary Internship Research, Competitor Social Media Analysis (April 2025)




### 3.3 Key Insights and What They Mean for HDFC Life

**Insight 1 - Value-Based Posts Work:** Value-Based content averaged 3.875 posts per 10 days -— the highest of all content types. In high-involvement financial categories, value-anchored communication significantly outperforms product-push advertising in generating brand consideration (Kotler & Keller, 2016). HDFC Life's April 2026 calendar plans 10 value-based posts, which is above the competitor average - a strength to build on.

**Insight 2 - Engagement Posts are Underutilised:** The industry average for Engagement posts was only 1.375 per 10 days. SBI Life stood out with 5 engagement posts - the highest of all brands. Engagement-type posts build community trust before purchase intent is triggered (Schiffman & Kanuk, 2010), and represent a low-cost, high-trust opportunity for HDFC Life.

**Insight 3 - Current Trend Posts Capture Attention, Not Intent:** Kotak Life and SBI Life used current trends (IPL) for 4+ posts each, gaining high reach but limited segment engagement. Trend-based posts primarily capture Attention in the AIDA funnel but rarely convert to Desire or Action without a value-specific follow-through message (Lavidge & Steiner, 1961).

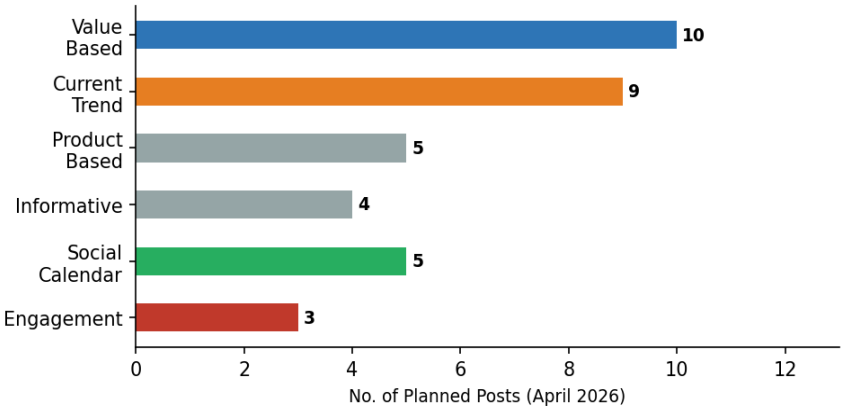
**Insight 4 - No Competitor Owns NJE or AfH:** Of 8 competitors analysed, none specifically targeted New Job Employees or Away-from-Home individuals in their April 2025 posts. Working Professionals dominated at an industry average of 9 posts per company. This represents a significant whitespace

opportunity for HDFC Life to own these two underserved segments through differentiated communication (Smith, 1956).

### 3.4 HDFC Life's Own Content Calendar - The Gap Identified

The chart below shows HDFC Life's planned content distribution for April 2026. While Value-Based posts lead at 10, a critical gap exists in segment-specificity - only 5 of 22 planned posting days explicitly name a target segment.

Figure 4: HDFC Life Planned Content Calendar — April 2026
Source: Internship Planning Document (HDFC Life, 2026)




This means the majority of value-based posts are directed at a generalised audience. The project's core task is to close this gap by mapping specific values to specific segments and automating that process using AI.

## 4. Framework and Methodology

The project applies three complementary analytical frameworks to move from problem identification to solution design.

### 4.1 STP Framework

The STP framework (Smith, 1956; Kotler & Keller, 2016) provides the overarching structure. Segmentation is complete - 15 consumer segments have been mapped across 16 life insurance values. Targeting focuses specifically on New Job Employees and Away-from-Home individuals. Positioning will be developed from questionnaire-derived value profiles, producing segment-specific positioning statements for HDFC Life's content team.

### 4.2 The AIDA Model and the Four-Step Content Design Framework

The AIDA model (Strong, 1925; Lavidge & Steiner, 1961) is used to assess communication effectiveness - whether content is moving a reader from Attention through to Action. This is operationalised through a four-step content design process used during the internship:

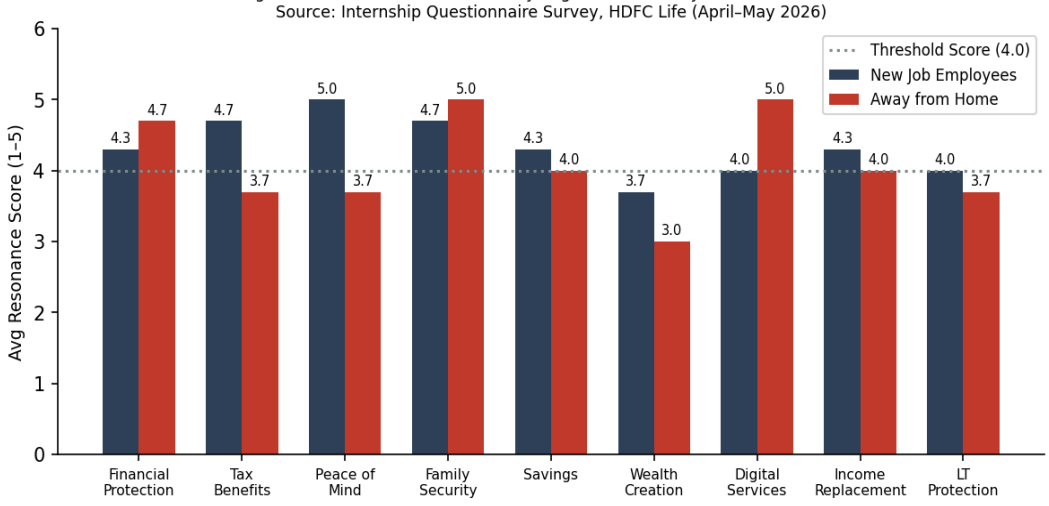
- Step 1 - Identify Value & Segment: Which insurance value is being communicated, and to which specific segment?
- Step 2 - Consumer Behaviour: What is the segment's key financial anxiety, life stage trigger, or decision-making driver?
- Step 3 - Central Idea: What single, emotionally resonant idea connects the value to the segment's behaviour?
- Step 4 - Script Writing: Draft the caption, visual description, and call-to-action for the post.

This four-step process is the foundation for the AI solution framework in Section 5, and has already been applied in the Engagement Post Strategy document produced during Week 3 of the internship.

### 4.3 Value Resonance Mapping

Value Resonance Mapping is the core analytical contribution of this project. It ranks 16 life insurance values by segment using primary Likert scale questionnaire data. The chart below shows preliminary findings from the initial 6 responses (3 per segment). Family Security and Digital Services scored highest for Away-from-Home individuals (5.0 each), while Family Security and Peace of Mind led for New Job Employees (5.0 each).

Figure 3: Value Resonance Scores by Segment — Primary Questionnaire Data
Source: Internship Questionnaire Survey, HDFC Life (April–May 2026)



These rankings will be validated with 30+ responses per segment in Weeks 4–6, then used to directly inform the AI tool's content recommendation logic. Consumer attitude measurement theory (Schiffman & Kanuk, 2010) underpins the Likert-scale design and weighted scoring approach.

### 4.4 Analytical Tools

The following analytical methods are applied sequentially to move from raw data to actionable insight:

| Tool | Application |
|---|---|
| **Descriptive Statistics** | Rank 16 values by average Likert score per segment; identify top 3–4 per segment |
| **Gap Analysis** | Compare HDFC Life's content calendar against segment value requirements and competitor benchmarks |
| **Pareto Analysis** | Identify the top 3–4 values driving 80% of purchase intent per segment (Juran, 1954) |
| **NLP Sentiment Analysis** | Analyse social media comment sentiment to validate value resonance findings from questionnaire data (Pang & Lee, 2008) |

## 5. Project Charter, Scope and Deliverables

### 5.1 Project Objectives

- Identify and rank the life insurance values that most strongly resonate with New Job Employees and Away-from-Home individuals, using primary questionnaire data validated against government secondary statistics.
- Extract actionable insights from the competitor social media analysis of 8 brands (April 2025), identifying patterns in content type, segment targeting, and value messaging.
- Design the AI-based Social Media Value-Segment Insight Generator and produce the FIIB AI Case Write-Up as the formal Intellectual Contribution.
- Request and analyse conversion rate data from HDFC Life to establish correlations between content type and policy acquisition outcomes.

### 5.2 Scope

| In Scope | Out of Scope |
|---|---|
| Value mapping for NJE and AfH segments (primary questionnaire + government data) | Product design, underwriting, actuarial, or pricing analysis |
| Competitor social media analysis - 8 brands, April 2025 | Legal or compliance review of advertising practices |
| HDFC Life content calendar analysis and gap identification | Live execution of any marketing campaign |
| Design of AI-based value mapping and content automation framework | Development of actual software or production-grade code |

### 5.3 Timeline

| Phase | Weeks | Key Activities | Milestone |
|---|---|---|---|
| **1: Immersion** | 1–3 (Apr 21 – May 9) | Induction; industry analysis; segment mapping; questionnaire design; competitor analysis; content calendar | AS1 submitted - Session 05 |
| **2: Insight Extraction** | 4–5 (May 12–23) | Extract and validate insights from competitor data; begin AI framework design; incorporate faculty feedback | Revised AS1 - Session 09 |
| **3: Data Deepening** | 5–6 (May 19–30) | Expand questionnaire to 30+ per segment; complete value resonance ranking for all three segments | Full primary dataset ready |
| **4: AI Framework Build** | 7–10 (Jun 2 – Jul 4) | Design AI prompt workflow; interim review; Level 1 demonstration to reporting manager | AI framework document |
| **5: Final Submission** | 11–12 (Jul 7–11) | Final report; AI Case Write-Up; viva preparation and presentation | Final submission & viva |

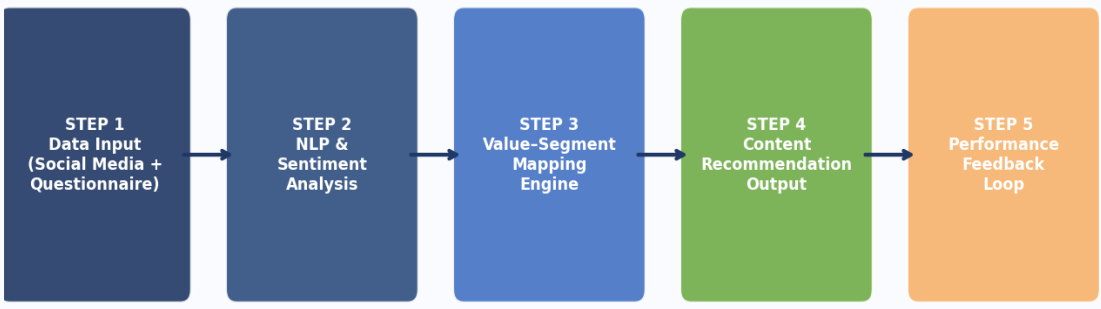
## 6. The AI Solution Framework (Intellectual Contribution)

The Intellectual Contribution for this project is an AI-based practical solution: a "Social Media Value-Segment Insight Generator." This addresses the operational problem identified in the first week of the internship: HDFC Life's BD team currently spends 3–5 hours per week manually analysing competitor social media posts, identifying content types, and deciding which values to target for which segments - without a structured framework, leading to inconsistency and inefficiency.

### 6.1 What the Tool Does

The solution is a structured AI prompt workflow (using ChatGPT or Claude.ai) that automates the competitor analysis and content recommendation process. It requires no coding and is fully operable by any BD team member. The five-step workflow is illustrated below.

Figure 5: Proposed AI-Based Value Mapping & Communication Automation Framework
Source: Developed by Author based on Faculty Mentor Guidance (May 2026)




| Step | Function | AI / Tech Layer | Business Output |
|---|---|---|---|
| **1. Data Input** | Ingest competitor post captions, engagement metrics, and questionnaire responses | CSV upload or copy-paste into prompt | Clean, structured dataset for analysis |
| **2. NLP & Sentiment Analysis** | Analyse caption language and value language frequency across posts | ChatGPT / Claude.ai prompt template or Brand24 / Sprout Social AI | Value resonance scores by post type and segment |
| **3. Value–Segment Mapping** | Cross-reference sentiment scores against the 16-value | Recommendation logic within the prompt workflow | Ranked value profiles per segment |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | framework and 15 consumer segments | | |
| **4. Content Recommendation** | Auto-generate segment-specific caption drafts and posting schedules using the 4-step framework | GPT-based content generation (OpenAI API or Claude.ai) | Ready-to-use content calendar with segment-value alignment |
| **5. Performance Feedback Loop** | Track actual post engagement; feed results back to improve recommendations | Instagram Insights API + Google Sheets dashboard | Self-improving system with monthly recalibration |

### 6.2 Why This Solves the Problem

This solution directly addresses the core problem by replacing manual, inconsistent content planning with an AI-assisted workflow that ensures every post is grounded in real competitor intelligence, the 16-value framework, and segment-specific targeting. A well-designed prompt template that saves the BD team measurable time per week is the target output. Personalised financial services communication has been shown to increase purchase intent by 31% over generic messaging (McKinsey & Company, 2022), and AI-driven content personalisation increases engagement rates by 35–40% over manually produced generic content (Liang et al., 2021).

### 6.3 Deployment Milestones

| Milestone | Activity | Target |
|---|---|---|
| **1. Problem Validation** | Confirm that 3–5 hours/week is spent on manual competitor analysis and document this as the problem baseline | Week 3 ✅ |
| **2. Prompt Build** | Design and test the AI prompt workflow using April 2025 competitor data; iterate until output is usable | Weeks 5–6 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **3. Level 1 Demo** | Demonstrate the working tool to the reporting manager using real HDFC Life data; document response | Week 7 |
| **4. Level 2 Attempt** | Share prompt template with BD team members; collect at least one colleague's usage and feedback | Weeks 8–10 |
| **5. AI Case Write-Up** | Complete full FIIB AI Case Write-Up with proof of solution (documented workflow + screenshots) | Weeks 11–12 |

## 7. Risks and Ethical Compliance

### 7.1 Key Risks

| Risk | Likelihood | Impact | Mitigation |
|---|---|---|---|
| Conversion rate data not accessible from HDFC Life | Medium | High | Use publicly available proxies (IRDAI channel-wise data); focus on engagement-to-inquiry correlation as proxy metric |
| Low questionnaire response rate beyond initial 6 responses | Medium | High | Expand outreach via FIIB network and WhatsApp; target 30+ responses per segment in Weeks 4–5 |
| AI tools identified may not be implementable within HDFC Life's existing tech infrastructure | Medium | Medium | Propose both a full-build and a ready-to-deploy SaaS option (e.g., Sprout Social AI, Brand24); keep recommendations tool-agnostic |
| Scope creep from additional corporate tasks assigned during internship | High | Medium | Document new tasks separately in internship log; maintain core project scope as defined above |

### 7.2 Ethical Compliance

- Informed Consent: All questionnaire respondents were informed of voluntary participation, anonymity, and academic-only use of their responses.
- Data Anonymisation: No personally identifiable information is stored or published. Only aggregate, segment-level findings are reported.
- Organisational Confidentiality: No proprietary HDFC Life data is disclosed beyond publicly available reports and what the reporting manager explicitly approved. The intern is bound by HDFC Life's standard NDA.
- Competitor Data Ethics: All competitor social media data was collected from publicly available pages. No private, paid or scraped data was used.

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## Annexures

1. Annexure A- https://forms.gle/Ae28oPdMHspWpVzbA New Job Employees & https://forms.gle/k8RVd8vLgFa6W9Po9 Away from Home
2. Annexure B- "C:\Users\HP\Desktop\CIP OFFICE\Planning_hdfc.xlsx" & "C:\Users\HP\Desktop\CIP OFFICE\SEGMENTS.xlsx"

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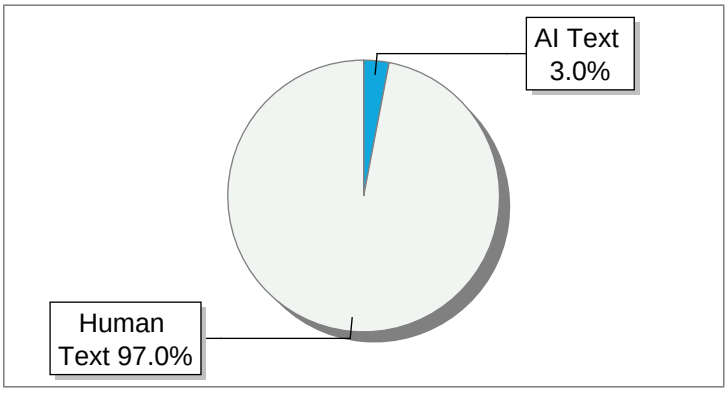
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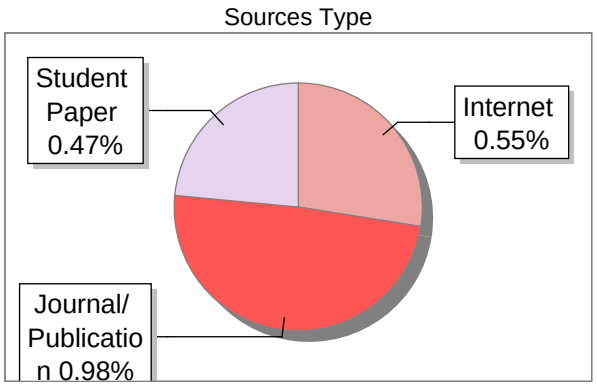
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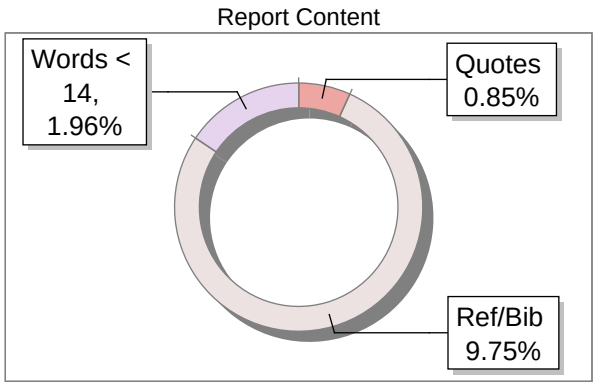
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